

29/06/2025

Hoarse, Keen, Scorching, Languid, Couch Potato

1. Hoarse (कर्कश) (Adjective) (hawrs) (Neutral / Slightly Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** Having a rough or harsh-sounding voice, usually due to illness or overuse.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** गला बैठ आ या आवाज़ भारी हो जाना।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *hārs* → **Middle English *hoorse*** → Modern *hoarse*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** rasping, gruff, husky
 - **Antonym:** clear, resonant
- **Connotation:** Typically implies physical discomfort or exhaustion
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A teacher shouting all day, now barely able to speak during the final period.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In voice training, recognizing the difference between a naturally deep voice and a hoarse voice is essential. A hoarse tone indicates strain or fatigue, often caused by shouting,

excessive talking, or illness. Public speakers and singers are especially vulnerable. Ignoring a hoarse throat can lead to vocal cord damage. Prevention involves hydration, vocal rest, and sometimes medical treatment.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- She sounded hoarse after cheering all night. (वह रात भर चिल्लाने के बाद गले से बैठी हुई लग रही थी।)
- She was hoarsing in the meeting. (Incorrect verb form; "hoarse" is not a verb.)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- If your voice gets hoarse, avoid whispering—it's worse for your vocal cords. Instead, rest and hydrate. Use honey and warm fluids to soothe the throat. Hoarseness is a warning; respect your vocal limits to avoid long-term issues.

- **Example + Hindi Equivalent + Grammatical Explanation:**

- His voice turned hoarse after back-to-back lectures. (उसकी आवाज़ लगातार व्याख्यानो के बाद बैठ गई।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): His voice
 - V (Verb – Linking): turned hoarse
 - O (Object): — (None; "hoarse" is a subject complement)
 - + (Adverbial Clause of Time): after back-to-back lectures
 - ↳ S: — (Implied subject: "he" or understood from context)
 - ↳ V: — (Non-finite; "after" + noun phrase "back-to-back lectures")

- **Common Collocations:**

- hoarse voice, hoarse whisper, sound hoarse

- **My Statement:**

- The hoarse whisper of the man caused some stress on me. ***
- The man's hoarse whisper made me feel stressed.
- We are expected to play with a hoarse player, but now we cannot go for it. ***
- We were expected to play with a hoarse player, but now we can't go ahead with it.
- The hoarse sound of the teacher gave me an unpleasant feeling. ***
- The teacher's hoarse voice gave me an unpleasant feeling.

2. Keen (तेज़/उत्सुक) (Adjective) (keen) (Positive)

- **Meaning (English):** Eager or enthusiastic; also means sharp or intense in perception.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** तीव्र इच्छा या तेज़ धार वाला।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Old English *cene* (brave, clever) → **Middle English *kene*** → Modern *keen*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** eager, sharp, enthusiastic
 - **Antonym:** indifferent, dull
- **Connotation:** Positive, implies enthusiasm or intelligence
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A student sitting in the front row, eyes wide open, absorbing every word.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

A keen mind is often a sign of intellectual curiosity. Employers value individuals who show keen interest in learning and adapting. Keen observations often lead to breakthrough insights in research and business. This quality is also seen in athletes who have a keen sense of timing and positioning. Whether it's a keen sense of smell or a keen desire to learn, it marks excellence.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- He has a keen interest in astronomy. (उसे खगोल विज्ञान में गहरी रुचि है।)
- She is keen of painting. (Incorrect preposition; should be "keen on painting.")

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- When describing enthusiasm or sharpness, "keen" fits both emotional and intellectual contexts. Remember: "keen **on** something" (interested), "keen **to** do something" (eager to act).

- **Example + Hindi Equivalent + Grammatical Explanation:**

- She is keen on solving puzzles. (वह पहेलियाँ सुलझाने में रुचि रखती है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Linking): is keen
 - O (Object): — (None; "keen" is an adjective describing the subject)
 - + (Prepositional Phrase / Adverbial Complement): on solving puzzles
 - ↳ S: — (Implied subject of "solving": she)
 - ↳ V: solving (gerund)
 - ↳ O: puzzles

- **Common Collocations:**

- keen interest, keen eye, keen sense, keen to learn

- **My Statement:**

- She has keen interest in swimming and plays it as a competitive sport. ***
- She has a keen interest in swimming and participates in it as a competitive sport.
- We are keen to learn to play musical instruments. ***
- We are keen to learn how to play musical instruments.
- Always stay keen to learn new things and try to incorporate them in your lives. ***
- Always stay eager to learn new things and try to incorporate them into your life.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

3. Scorching (झुलसा देने वाला) (Adjective) (skor-ching) (Negative / Intense)

- **Meaning (English):** Extremely hot; can also mean intense or harsh (emotionally or physically).
- **Meaning (Hindi):** बहुत ज़्यादा गर्म या जलाने वाला।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Middle English *scorchen* → from Old North French *escorcher* (to burn)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** blazing, searing, sweltering
 - **Antonym:** chilly, mild, cool
- **Connotation:** Usually negative or intense
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Asphalt roads steaming in the sun, people shading their eyes with hands.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Scorching temperatures are now a global concern due to climate change. Several cities record temperatures beyond 45°C, disrupting daily life, causing heat strokes, and affecting outdoor work. In journalism, “scorching criticism” may refer to severe public backlash. Whether literal or metaphorical, the word adds intensity to any description.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- The scorching sun made walking unbearable. (झुलसा देने वाली धूप में चलना मुश्किल था।)
- It was a scorching cold day. (Contradictory usage; "scorching" and "cold" don't go together.)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Use "scorching" to describe not just weather, but also harsh reviews or intense speeches. It's a vivid word that adds emotional and sensory depth to your writing.

- **Example + Hindi Equivalent + Grammatical Explanation:**

- She gave a scorching response to the false accusations. (उसने झूठे आरोपों पर तीखा जवाब दिया।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): She
 - V (Verb – Transitive): gave
 - O (Object): a scorching response
 - + (Prepositional Phrase): to the false accusations
 - ↳ O (Object of the preposition): the false accusations
 - ↳ Det: the
 - ↳ Adj: false
 - ↳ Noun: accusations

- **Common Collocations:**

- scorching heat, scorching sun, scorching criticism

- **My Statement:**

- I have come home travelling in a scorching heat, now I need to take a bath. ***
- I came home after travelling in the scorching heat; now I need to take a bath.
- It is a scorching sun outside, how will you go in such weather. ***
- It's scorching outside—how will you go out in such weather?
- The journalist gave a scorching criticism to the proposed policy that can ruin the integrity of the nation. ***
- The journalist gave a scorching critique of the proposed policy, which could undermine the nation's integrity.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

4. Languid (शिथिल / धीमा) (Adjective) (lan-gwid) (Neutral / Slightly Negative)

- **Meaning (English):** Slow, relaxed, or lacking in energy or spirit
- **Meaning (Hindi):** थका हुआ या ऊर्जा रहित
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Latin *languere* (to be weak) → **French *languide*** → English *languid*
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** sluggish, lethargic, weary
 - **Antonym:** energetic, vigorous
- **Connotation:** Slightly negative; implies fatigue or lack of enthusiasm
- **Pictorial Scenario:** Someone lying on a couch staring blankly at the ceiling, barely moving.



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

In literary writing, "languid" often describes slow-paced scenes or emotional detachment. A languid atmosphere might suggest peace, or boredom depending on context. In healthcare, it may describe the state of a patient recovering from illness. The word also appears in lifestyle descriptions, such as languid afternoons or movements.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- He walked with a languid pace, lost in thought. (वह धीमी चाल में चल रहा था, सोच में डूबा हुआ।)
- She was too languidly. (Incorrect adverb use; "languid" is adjective; "languidly" is adverb)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Use "languid" to describe peaceful slowness or emotional fatigue. It fits moods, pace, or physical states. Perfect for literature, lifestyle, or introspective writing.

- **Example + Hindi Equivalent + Grammatical Explanation:**

- The summer afternoon was languid and silent. (गर्मी की दोपहर सुस्त और शांत थी।)

- **Grammar Breakdown:**

- S (Subject): The summer afternoon
- V (Verb – Linking): was
- O (Subject Complement – Adjectives): languid and silent
- + (Modifiers in Subject):
 - ↳ Det: The
 - ↳ Adj: summer
 - ↳ Noun: afternoon

- **Common Collocations:**

- languid pace, languid mood, languid afternoon

- **My Statement:**

- We live at a languid pace when we are in the village, where no one is in a hurry like in the cities. ***
- We live at a languid pace in the village, where no one is in a rush like in the cities.
- The soothing music sets a languid mood where I can peacefully lie down and do nothing. ***
- The soothing music sets a languid mood where I can peacefully lie down and do nothing.
- We have a languid player in our team but he often acts aggressively at the last moment. ***

- We have a languid player on our team, but he often becomes aggressive at the last moment.
- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]

5. Couch Potato (आलसी व्यक्ति) (Noun) (kowch puh-tay-toh) (Negative / Humorous)

- **Meaning (English):** A person who spends a lot of time sitting or lying down watching TV or doing nothing physically active.
- **Meaning (Hindi):** जो व्यक्ति पूरा दिन टीवी देखता रहे या कोई शारीरिक गतिविधि ना करे।
- **Origin Flowchart & Etymology:**
 - Slang origin in 1970s U.S. pop culture → "couch" (sofa) + "potato" (suggesting inactivity)
- **Synonym + Antonym:**
 - **Synonym:** slacker, lazybones
 - **Antonym:** go-getter, active person
- **Connotation:** Humorous but mildly critical
- **Pictorial Scenario:** A man in pajamas with snacks on his belly watching TV all day



- **Use in Non-Fiction (100 words):**

Health experts warn against becoming a couch potato due to rising sedentary lifestyles. This term humorously describes someone who avoids physical activity and prefers screen time. Long-term inactivity is linked to obesity, diabetes, and heart disease. While relaxation is important, being a chronic couch potato can undermine health goals.

- **Correct and Incorrect Usage:**

- He turned into a couch potato after quitting sports. (खेल छोड़ने के बाद वह पूरी तरह सुस्त हो गया।)
- He is couch potatoing at home. ("Couch potato" is a noun, not a verb.)

- **Word Hack of the Day (50 words):**

- Don't let comfort turn into laziness. If you're binge-watching for hours, balance it with stretches or light activity. Avoid being a couch potato—your body will thank you later.

- **Example + Hindi Equivalent + Grammatical Explanation:**

- Since summer break started, she has become a couch potato. (गर्मी की छुट्टियाँ शुरू होने के बाद से वह पूरी तरह आलसी हो गई है।)
- **Grammar Breakdown:**
 - S (Subject): she
 - V (Verb – Linking): has become
 - O (Subject Complement – Noun Phrase): a couch potato
 - + (Adverbial Clause of Time): Since summer break started
 - ↳ S: summer break
 - ↳ V: started

- **Common Collocations:**

- become a couch potato, act like a couch potato, avoid being a couch potato

- **My Statement:**

- We can avoid being a couch potato by setting a goal for ourselves. ***
- We can avoid becoming a couch potato by setting goals for ourselves.
- He turned into a couch potato after buying a TV which has a lot of shows to watch. ***
- He turned into a couch potato after buying a TV with countless shows to watch.
- He acts like a couch potato in the winter; but in summer he works very hard. ***
- He acts like a couch potato in winter, but works very hard in summer.

- **My Notes:** [Leave as Placeholder]